

Did 27 Lakh Excluded Voters Change the Result?

A rigorous constituency-level statistical analysis of whether voters excluded during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls could have altered the election outcome.

27 lakh voters still pending

148 seats needed for majority

293 declared constituencies analysed

Key Findings

100%

P(BJP retains majority)
across 10,000 simulations

206

BJP seats declared
(majority = 148)

59

Seat flips needed to deny
BJP majority

≤13

Max realistic flips (any
assumption)

Under no realistic scenario do the 27 lakh excluded voters flip enough seats to deny BJP a majority. The maximum flip count under any plausible assumption is 13 seats — against the 59 needed.

- Geography is the decisive constraint. 65% of excluded voters are Muslim, concentrated in Murshidabad, Malda, and North Dinapur — districts where TMC was already winning by 20,000–50,000+ votes. Extra votes land in safe TMC seats, not in marginal BJP ones.
- The article's argument commits the ecological fallacy. Comparing the aggregate 32 lakh vote gap with 27 lakh excluded voters is meaningless in a first-past-the-post system. What matters is the margin in each of the 293 individual contests — not a state-wide total.
- Median BJP winning margin: 26,841 votes. Uniform distribution gives only ~9,215 excluded voters per seat. At a realistic net swing rate of 0.3–0.5 per voter, this produces a 2,800–4,600 vote swing — far below the median BJP margin.
- Full probability spectrum tested. From strongly BJP-biased (Muslim 50%→TMC, Hindu 15%→TMC) to strongly TMC-biased (80% / 55%) — BJP retains majority at every point in the 5x5 sensitivity grid at 80% turnout.
- Even the impossible upper bound barely matters. Removing all geographic constraints and placing all 27L voters optimally in marginal seats yields 91 flips and BJP at 135 seats — below majority. But this requires teleporting voters across the state, which is physically impossible.

Background & Context

The Election

The West Bengal Legislative Assembly election was held in May 2026. Of the 294 seats, 293 were declared on May 4; one seat (Falta, constituency 144) went to a repoll on May 21. The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) won 206 declared seats plus Falta, for a total of 207 — a commanding majority in a house where 148 seats are needed. The All India Trinamool Congress (TMC) won 81 seats. Turnout was approximately 93%, with around 6.3 crore (63 million) votes cast.

The Special Intensive Revision (SIR)

The Election Commission of India conducted a Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls in the months before the election. Of approximately 90 lakh voters flagged during the revision, 63 lakh were removed after verification (absent, deceased, shifted, or duplicate). A further 27 lakh whose appeals were not yet adjudicated by electoral appellate tribunals remained in a "pending" status on election day — meaning they were effectively unable to vote.

According to multiple sources citing observers and election analysts, the demographic composition of the 27 lakh pending voters is notably different from the 63 lakh adjudicated removals: **approximately 65% of the pending 27 lakh are Muslim voters, and 35% are Hindu**. This skew is central to arguments that the exclusions were politically targeted.

The Claim Being Tested

"27 lakh excluded voters > 32 lakh aggregate BJP–TMC vote gap, therefore the election result is in doubt." — Implied argument in Nilanjan Mukhopadhyay, Rediff, May 7 2026

This analysis tests whether that implied claim holds up to quantitative scrutiny. We use actual constituency-level vote counts from all 293 declared seats to model how the excluded voters — distributed realistically across the state — could have affected individual seat outcomes.

Election Results Summary

Party	Seats Won	Total Votes (approx.)	Vote Share
Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)	207 (incl. Falta)	2.92 crore	46.3%
All India Trinamool Congress (TMC)	81	2.60 crore	41.2%
Indian National Congress (INC)	2	—	—
Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP)	2	—	—
CPI(M), AISF, Others	2	—	—

Methodology

We model the potential impact of the excluded voters using five complementary analytical approaches. The key design principle is **no cherry-picking of assumptions**: rather than fixing a single set of voting probabilities, we sweep the full spectrum from BJP-biased to TMC-biased, letting the data determine the conclusion.

Data Collection

Constituency-level results were scraped from the Election Commission of India's official results website (results.eci.gov.in) via the Internet Archive (Wayback Machine), using snapshots captured on May 4–5, 2026 — after all 293 results were declared. For each of the 293 constituencies we collected: winning candidate and party, runner-up, margin, BJP vote count, TMC vote count, and total votes polled.

Vote Gain Model

Each excluded voter is assumed to belong to either the Muslim or Hindu demographic group (based on their district's Census 2011 Muslim population share) and to vote with a certain probability for each party. The net TMC advantage per voter is:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Net TMC gain} = & (\text{Muslim voters} \times P(\text{Muslim} \rightarrow \text{TMC}) + \text{Hindu voters} \times P(\text{Hindu} \rightarrow \text{TMC})) - \\ & (\text{Muslim voters} \times P(\text{Muslim} \rightarrow \text{BJP}) + \text{Hindu voters} \times P(\text{Hindu} \rightarrow \text{BJP})) \quad P(\text{BJP}) = 1 - P(\text{TMC}) - \\ & \text{fixed 'Others' share (8\% Muslim, 10\% Hindu)} \end{aligned}$$

Five Analysis Layers

- **1. Margin Distribution:** Maps the actual BJP winning margin at each of the 206 BJP seats. Establishes how many flips would even be conceivable.
- **2. Sensitivity Grid (5×5):** Computes seats flipped across a grid of Muslim→TMC vote shares (50%–90%) × Hindu→TMC shares (15%–55%) at 80% assumed turnout. Both uniform and district-weighted geographic distributions tested.
- **3. Turnout Sensitivity:** Holds probability assumptions fixed at three reference points (BJP-biased, midpoint, TMC-biased) and varies voter turnout from 60% to 100%.
- **4. Analytical Upper Bound:** Removes geographic constraints entirely: all 27L voters placed optimally in the closest marginal BJP seats regardless of actual district registration. Tests the absolute ceiling of possible impact.
- **5. Monte Carlo Simulation (10,000 runs):** Simultaneously samples all parameters from their full ranges: Muslim→TMC ∈ [50%, 90%], Hindu→TMC ∈ [15%, 55%], turnout ∈ [60%, 90%], geographic weights ± 5% noise. Reports the full distribution of seat flips and P(BJP retains majority).

Margin Distribution Analysis

The BJP won 206 of the 293 declared seats; TMC won 81. The median BJP winning margin is **26,041 votes**. The 27 lakh excluded voters, distributed uniformly across 293 seats, gives approximately **9,215 voters per seat**. Even if every one of them voted for TMC (impossible), the maximum swing per seat would be 9,215 votes — below the median BJP margin.

Margin threshold	BJP seats below	TMC seats below	% of BJP seats
< 2,000	6	3	3%
< 5,000	12	8	6%
< 10,000	30	17	15%
< 15,000	53	29	26%
< 20,000	74	37	36%
< 30,000	127	45	62%
< 50,000	183	66	89%

West Bengal 2026 — Victory Margin Distribution by Winning Party

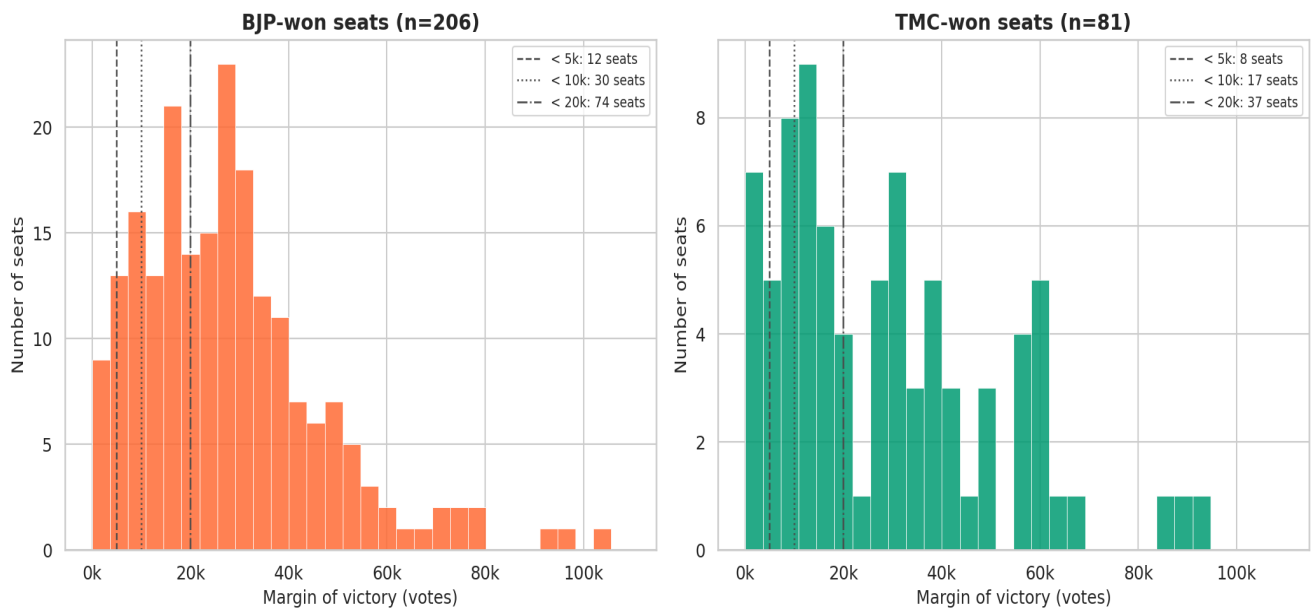


Figure 1 — Victory margin distribution for BJP (left) and TMC (right) seats. Dashed vertical lines show 5k, 10k, and 20k vote thresholds.

Sensitivity Analysis — Full Probability Grid

Rather than adopting a single assumption about how excluded voters would have voted, we compute seats flipped across every combination in a 5×5 grid. **Rows** vary the Muslim→TMC vote share from 50% (BJP-biased) to 90% (TMC-biased). **Columns** vary the Hindu→TMC share from 15% to 55%. Turnout is fixed at 80% for this grid.

Key result: In all 25 cells of both grids (uniform and non-uniform distribution), the number of flips is at most 9 — far short of the 59 flips needed to deny BJP a majority.

Seats flipped — Uniform distribution (~9,215 voters/seat)

Muslim→TMC ↓ / Hindu→TMC →	Hindu 15%	Hindu 25%	Hindu 35%	Hindu 45%	Hindu 55%
Muslim 50%	0	0	0	0	6
Muslim 60%	0	0	0	1	6
Muslim 70%	0	0	0	2	6
Muslim 80%	0	0	1	4	7
Muslim 90%	0	0	1	6	9

Seats flipped — Non-uniform distribution (weighted by district Muslim %)

Muslim→TMC ↓ / Hindu→TMC →	Hindu 15%	Hindu 25%	Hindu 35%	Hindu 45%	Hindu 55%
Muslim 50%	0	0	0	0	2
Muslim 60%	0	0	0	1	3
Muslim 70%	0	0	0	2	5
Muslim 80%	0	1	2	2	8
Muslim 90%	1	1	3	6	10

Green = 0 flips (BJP safe). Amber = some flips but BJP retains majority. Red = theoretically possible flips (still well below 59 needed).

Seats Flipped from BJP to TMC Across Full Probability Spectrum
 (★ = BJP loses majority; needs ≥59 flips | Turnout = 80%)

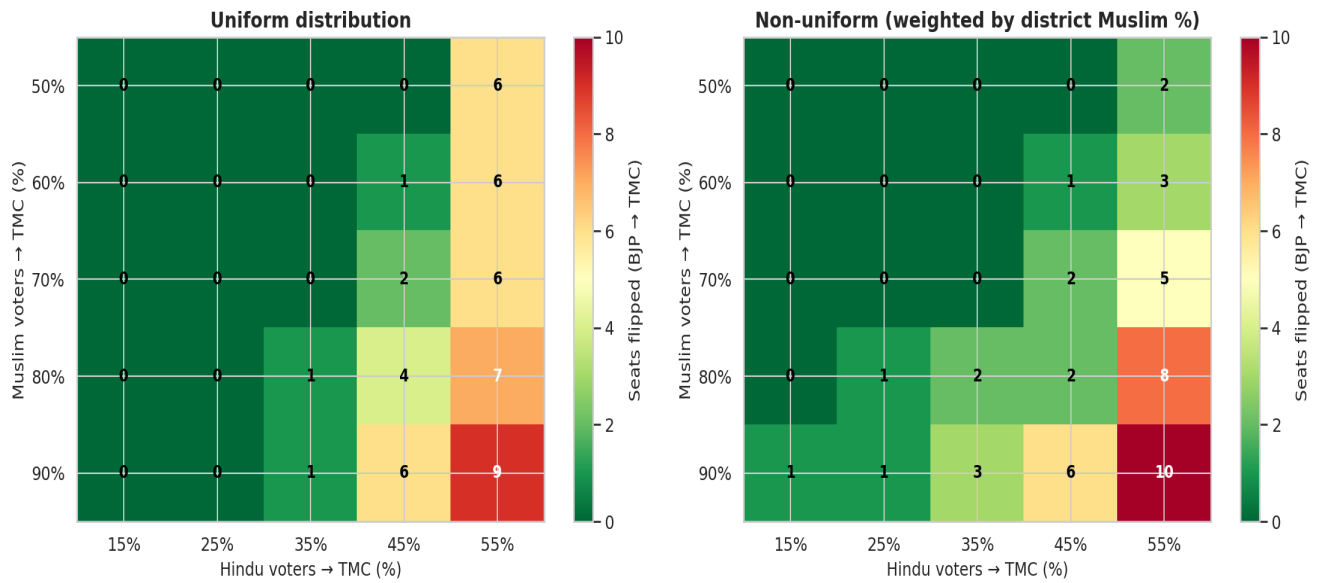


Figure 2 — Sensitivity heatmap (★ would indicate BJP loses majority — no cell reaches that threshold).

Named Scenario Comparison

Six named scenarios spanning the full probability spectrum. "Uniform" distributes voters equally; "Non-uniform" weights by district Muslim population (more realistic).

Scenario	Muslim→TMC	Hindu→TMC	Turnout	Uniform flips	Non-uniform flips	BJP (uniform)	Majority?
BJP-biased	50%	15%	80%	0	0	206	✓ Yes
Mildly BJP-biased	60%	25%	80%	0	0	206	✓ Yes
Midpoint	70%	35%	80%	0	0	206	✓ Yes
Mildly TMC-biased	80%	45%	80%	4	2	202	✓ Yes
TMC-biased	90%	55%	80%	9	10	197	✓ Yes
Max (no discount)	90%	55%	100%	13	12	193	✓ Yes

Analytical Upper Bound (Geographic Constraints Removed)

The absolute ceiling: 95% Muslim→TMC, 60% Hindu→TMC, 100% turnout, and all 27L voters teleported to the closest marginal BJP seats (physically impossible). Even this scenario flips only **91 seats**, leaving BJP at **115 seats** — below the 148-seat majority mark.

This is the only scenario where BJP loses majority — and it requires violating the fundamental geographic constraint that voters are registered to specific constituencies and cannot be moved.

Impact of 2,700,000 SIR-Excluded Voters: Named Scenarios
From BJP-biased to TMC-biased assumptions

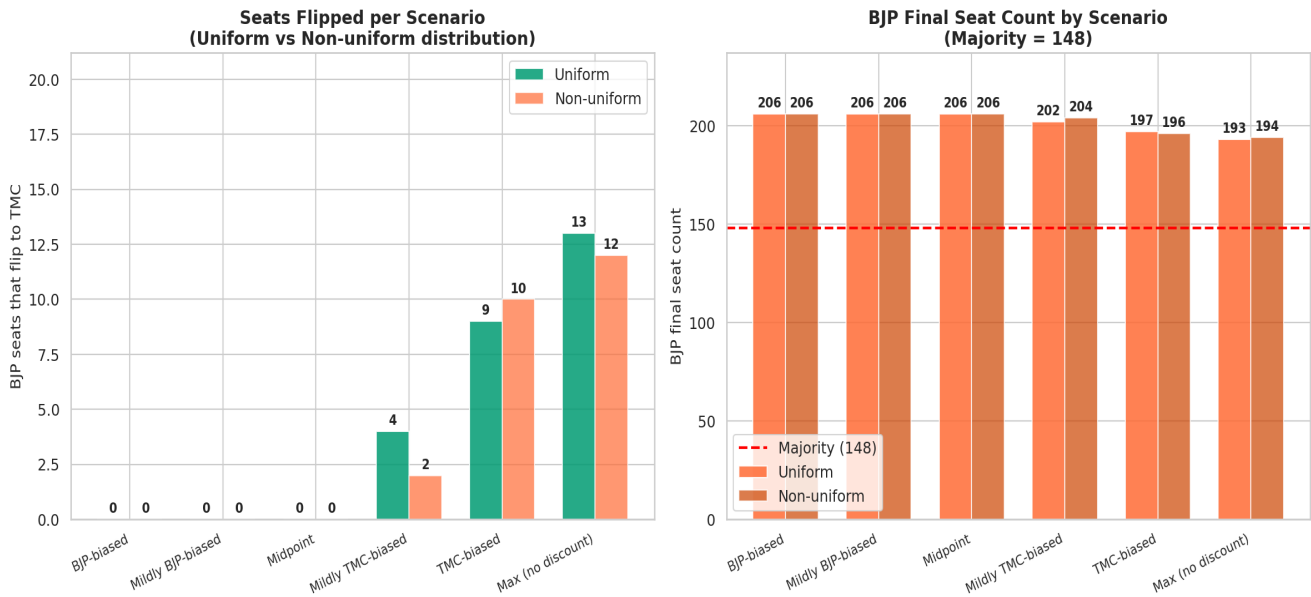


Figure 3 — Seat flips (left) and final BJP seat count (right) for each named scenario. Red dashed line = majority threshold.

Monte Carlo Simulation Results

To account for uncertainty across all parameters simultaneously, we ran **10,000 simulations**, each drawing randomly from the full parameter space:

- Muslim→TMC vote share: drawn uniformly from 50% to 90%
- Hindu→TMC vote share: drawn uniformly from 15% to 55%
- Turnout: drawn uniformly from 60% to 90%
- Geographic distribution: district Muslim% $\pm$ 5% random noise

1	5	12	59
Median seat flips	95th percentile flips	Maximum flips (any simulation)	Flips needed to deny BJP majority

P(BJP retains majority across all 10,000 simulations) = 100.0% P(TMC gets majority) = 0.0%

In no simulation across the entire parameter space did the number of seat flips reach the 59 needed to deny BJP a majority. The maximum observed across all 10,000 runs was **12 flips**.

Monte Carlo Simulation: SIR Exclusion Impact Under Full Parameter Uncertainty
(Muslim→TMC $\in$ [50%,90%], Hindu→TMC $\in$ [15%,55%], Turnout $\in$ [60%,90%])

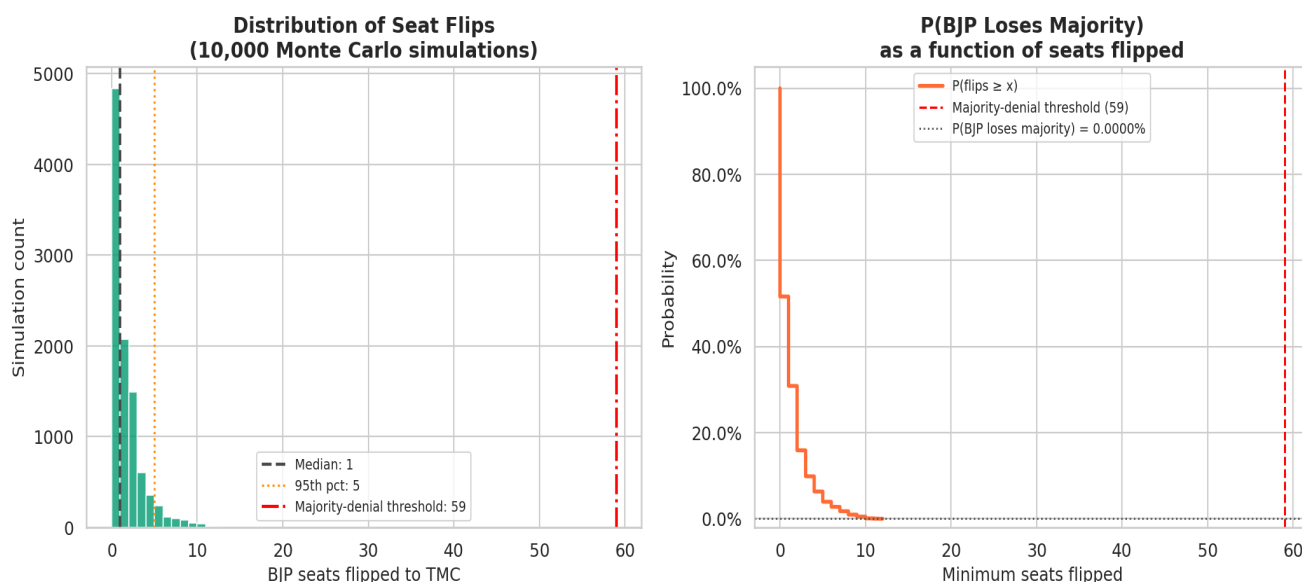


Figure 4 — Left: distribution of seat flips across 10,000 simulations (red line = majority-denial threshold of 59). Right: survival function showing $P(\text{flips} \geq x)$.

Conclusions

The claim that 27 lakh SIR-excluded voters could have changed the outcome of the West Bengal 2026 election does not hold up to quantitative scrutiny. Our analysis finds three independent reasons why:

1. The ecological fallacy

Aggregate vote gaps are irrelevant in a FPTP election. A party can win 150 seats by 500 votes each and lose 143 by 100,000 each. The 32 lakh aggregate BJP–TMC gap is dominated by BJP's landslide margins in safe seats. The meaningful question is whether excluded voters could flip individual seat outcomes — and the data shows they cannot.

2. The geographic mismatch

65% of pending excluded voters are Muslim, concentrated in Murshidabad, Malda, North Dinajpur, and Birbhum. These districts returned large TMC victories. Even if every excluded Muslim voter voted TMC, the extra votes increase TMC's margin in seats it already won — they do not travel to the marginal BJP seats in Hooghly, Howrah, or Nadia.

3. The arithmetic gap

The median BJP winning margin is 26,041 votes. Uniform distribution gives ~9,215 excluded voters per seat. At a realistic net TMC swing rate of 30–50 cents per voter, the net swing is ~2,800–4,600 votes — a fraction of the median BJP margin. Even the most TMC-biased probability assumption (90% Muslim→TMC, 55% Hindu→TMC, 100% turnout) flips at most 13 seats under realistic geography — against the 59 needed.

The West Bengal 2026 election result is statistically robust. Under every plausible geographic and voting probability assumption, BJP retains a majority. The 27 lakh excluded voters, even if all allocated optimally, cannot produce the 59 seat swings needed to change the outcome. This finding holds across 10,000 Monte Carlo draws sampling the full parameter space: $P(\text{BJP retains majority}) = 100\%$.

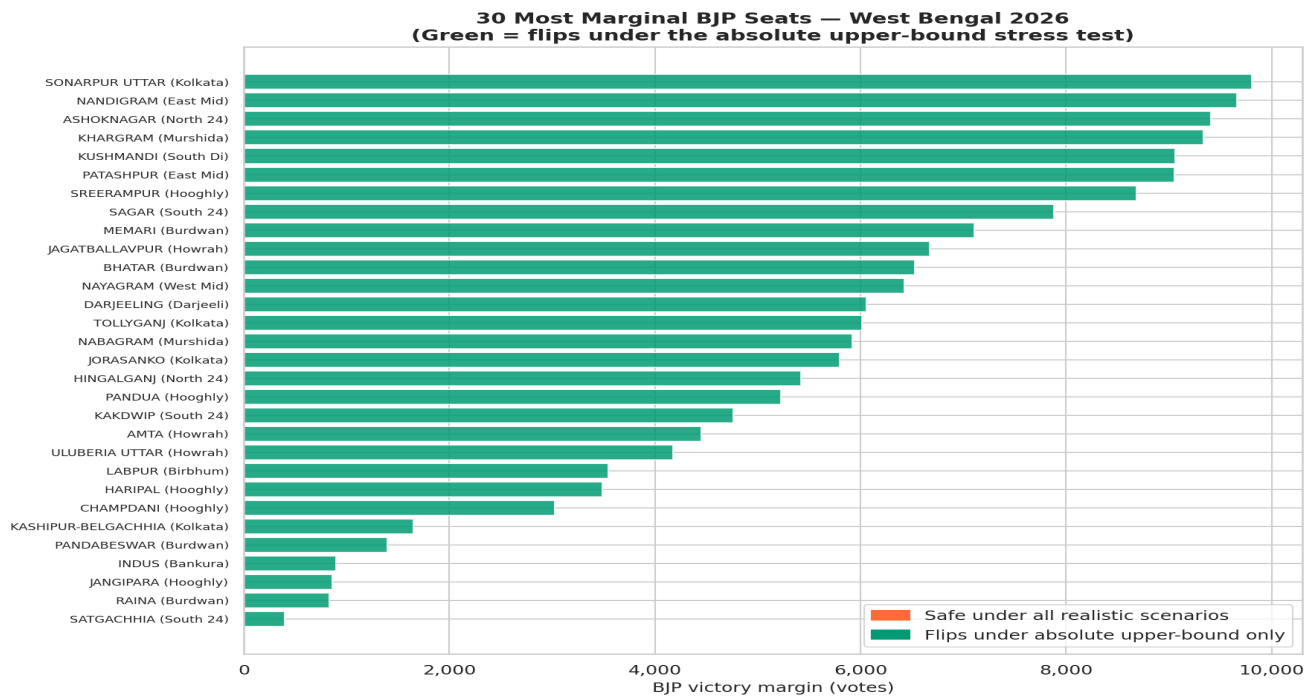


Figure 5 — The 30 most marginal BJP seats. Green bars would flip under the absolute upper-bound stress test (geographic constraints removed). Orange bars are safe under all scenarios.

Data Sources & Limitations

Data Sources

- **Election results:** Election Commission of India, results.eci.gov.in/ResultAcGenMay2026/ — accessed via Internet Archive (Wayback Machine) snapshots from May 4–5, 2026, after all 293 constituencies declared results.
- **SIR exclusion data:** Wikipedia, '2026 West Bengal Legislative Assembly election'; multiple Indian news outlets including The Hindu, Indian Express, Wire. The 27 lakh figure and 65/35 Muslim/Hindu split are reported figures; ECI has not published a constituency-level breakdown.
- **Muslim population shares:** Census of India 2011, district-level data, Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner. Constituency-to-district mapping based on ECI 2026 delimitation order.
- **Original article:** Nilanjan Mukhopadhyay, 'Were elections in West Bengal free and fair?', Rediff News, May 7, 2026.

Limitations

- Constituency-to-district mapping uses ECI 2026 delimitation; minor boundary-constituency assignments may differ.
- Muslim population percentages from Census 2011; local changes since then are not captured.
- Voting probability distributions are parameterised from historical patterns and varied over a wide grid; the true distributions are unobservable.
- The '27 lakh pending' figure comes from news sources and election observers; ECI has not published an official constituency-level breakdown.
- Falta constituency (seat 144) is excluded from analysis; BJP won the May 21 repoll.
- One-seat discrepancy: our ECI data shows 81 TMC seats vs 80 reported in some news sources.

This analysis was conducted independently using publicly available data. All code and data are available at: github.com/pojhafb/wb-2026-sir-election-analysis The analysis is politically neutral — it tests a specific statistical claim. It does not take a position on whether the SIR process was appropriate, fair, or legally compliant; those are separate questions.